



The Computer Programmer



Ada Lovelace is considered one of the world's first computer programmers. Before computers as we know existed, Ada understood that computers could follow sets of instructions to carry out complex calculations.

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Ada was a wealthy woman in England in the 1800s. Her father was Lord Byron, one of the greatest poets of the time. However, Byron left Ada's family soon after she was born. She grew up with her mother who encouraged her education.

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Unlike many of the women in her social circle, Ada loved to study math and science. In fact, she was brilliant at these subjects.

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At seventeen, Ada met the inventor Charles Babbage. They started work on a project together. Babbage had designed a machine called the Analytical Engine, which was designed to solve difficult mathematical calculations.

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Ada wrote detailed notes in 1843 about the Analytical Engine. She created an algorithm for it. This became known as the first algorithm designed for a machine to carry out. Ada understood this engine could follow patterns (or codes), the basis of computer programming.

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In 1953, Ada's notes were republished and her work was finally given the recognition it deserved. The Analytical Engine is acknowledged as an early computer model. Ada's notes describe the computer.

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To this day, Ada Lovelace inspires many young women to further their interests in computer programming.

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